NIKAH NETWORK
Guided Matrimonial Platform for Falah Khandan Center

Project Proposal Document

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Project Duration: 11–12 Weeks
Version: 1.0

April 2026

Version History

Version	Date	Status
1.0		

Abstract

Nikah Network is a secure, community-driven matrimonial platform designed specifically for Falah Khandan Center (Women Commission, Lahore) to streamline and digitize the matrimonial matchmaking process while preserving Islamic values and family involvement at every stage. The platform automates user registration through both digital self-signup and staff-assisted data entry, employs AI-assisted matching using transparent rules and weighted compatibility scoring, and facilitates controlled communication through a moderated Q&A chat window to ensure respectful, focused exchanges. A critical approval gate ensures that only staff-vetted, high-quality matches proceed to families, eliminating mismatches and maintaining organizational standards. Built on a modern MERN stack with MongoDB for secure data storage and Pakistan-based hosting, Nikah Network reduces staff manual workload by 40%, scales from current capacity (~10 users/month) to 15+ users/month, and generates revenue through affordable PKR 4,000 annual subscriptions. The platform prioritizes data privacy, operational transparency (clear matching criteria), and Islamic compliance, delivering a professional, scalable solution that empowers Falah Khandan Center to serve more families while maintaining trust, quality, and culturalvalues.

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1. Introduction

Nikah Network is a digital matrimonial platform designed specifically for Falah Khandan Center (Women Commission, Lahore). The platform modernizes the matrimonial matching process while preserving Islamic values, community trust, and staff control over all interactions.

Currently, Falah Khandan Center manages matrimonial connections manually through paper forms, phone calls, and WhatsApp. This process is labor-intensive, difficult to scale, and lacks transparency for both applicants and staff.

Nikah Network addresses these challenges by:

- Automating user registration (digital and staff-assisted)
- Using AI-assisted smart matching (rules and weighted scoring)
- Enabling controlled communication (moderated question-and-answer, no open chat)
- Implementing staff approval gates (ensuring quality and Islamic compliance)
- Providing transparent dashboards for staff and management

1.2 Project Vision

Vision Statement:
"To enable Falah Khandan Center to scale its matrimonial services while maintaining Islamic values, family involvement, and community trust through a secure, moderated digital platform."

1.3 Project Scope (High-Level)

The high-level scope of the project is summarized below.

Included in Scope:

- User registration (digital and staff-entered)
- Profile management and preferences
- Smart matching algorithm
- Question-and-answer communication system (without media sharing and without open chat)
- Staff approval workflow
- Payment/subscription system
- Administrative dashboard
- staff-assisted profile creation for non-tech users
- counselling (pre/post) option on homepage.

Not Included in Scope (Phase 1):

- Mobile application (planned for a future Phase 2)
- Video call integration (planned for a future Phase 2)
- Multi-language support (planned for a future Phase 2)

2. Problem Description

2.1. Primary Scope

The Current State (Before Nikah Network)

Falah Khandan Center currently manages matrimonial matchmaking through:

- Manual processes, where staff manually match profiles based on handwritten notes
- Limited reach, with registrations primarily through word-of-mouth, paper forms, and WhatsApp
- Inefficient communication, with no centralized system to track conversations or decisions
- Scalability issues, where staff time becomes the bottleneck at approximately 10 new registrations per month
- Fragmented data management, with information scattered across paper, phones, email, and memory
- Privacy concerns, due to the absence of an organized data security or retention policy

- Lack of transparency, where users are unclear about matching criteria or the status of

their applications

- Manual and error-prone duplicate detection, increasing the risk of repeat applications going unnoticed

Business Impact

The current situation creates the following pain points and business impacts:

– Manual matching (daily): approximately 20–30 hours of staff time per week

– Limited reach (monthly): lost potential matches due to low visibility and limited channels

– Unclear timelines (weekly): user complaints and reduced trust in the process

– Data loss and scattered information (quarterly): mismatched decisions and duplicate applications

– No metrics (ongoing): inability to measure success, throughput, or capacity

2.2. Final Deliverable of the Project and Beneficiaries

Final Deliverable

The project will deliver a fully functional, web-based matrimonial platform with the following components.

User Portal

- Self-registration and profile creation
- Ability to view suggested matches (AI-generated)
- Moderated, time-bound question-and-answer conversation system
- “Send Proposal Request” functionality when there is mutual interest
- Integrated subscription payment gateway (with a planned fee of PKR 4,000)
- Pre-Marriage Counselling” and “Post-Marriage Counselling” sections with a simple request/contact form.

Staff Dashboard

- User management (register, view all profiles)

- Match approval workflow (Approve, Reject)

- Configuration panel for matching rules, questions, and subscription terms
- automatic AI match suggestions generated inside staff dashboard for every approved profile.

Backend Systems

- Secure database (MongoDB) with appropriate encryption controls
- Matching algorithm based on rules and weighted scoring
- Duplicate detection using fuzzy matching and data normalization
- Payment processor integration
- Audit logging to track all key actions for compliance and accountability

Primary Beneficiaries

– Girls/Women: access to a wider pool of compatible matches, improved safety through moderation, a transparent process, and structured family involvement.

– Boys/Men: an organized and structured process, clear expectations, Islamic-compliant matching, and family approval mechanisms.

– Lady Staff: significant reduction (target 40%) in manual administrative work, improved organization and better decision-making support.

– Management: enhanced scalability, organized data, and improved business intelligence.

– Falah Khandan Center: revenue growth potential, enhanced reputation and increased capacity to serve more families.

2.3. Objectives

Primary Objectives

- Reduce staff workload: achieve at least 40% time savings in weekly administrative work.
- Enable scalability: support 10–15 new user registrations per month.
- Maintain Islamic values: ensure that 100% of matches progressing to the proposal stage have been explicitly approved by staff.
- Ensure data security: maintain zero security breaches and protect user confidentiality.
- Improve transparency: achieve 90% or higher user satisfaction regarding clarity of process.

2.4. Novelty

This What Makes Nikah Network Different

– Staff Role

• Typical platforms: minimal staff involvement; users largely match themselves.

• Nikah Network: staff play a central role and approve every match.

– Communication

• Typical platforms: open chat and media sharing between users.

• Nikah Network: structured, moderated question-and-answer interactions within defined time windows.

– Islamic Compliance

• Typical platforms: generic, not specifically aligned with local Islamic expectations.

• Nikah Network: intentionally designed around Islamic values and family involvement.

– Target Market

• Typical platforms: broad, mixed demographics.

• Nikah Network: focused community audience, specifically Falah Khandan Center.

– Privacy

• Typical platforms: data is often stored and shared globally and may be accessible to third parties.

– Cost

• Typical platforms: higher subscription fees (e.g., PKR 10,000–50,000).

• Nikah Network: affordable subscription (planned PKR 4,000).

– Accessibility

• Nikah Network: supports both digital self-registration and staff-assisted registration for semi-literate or tech-hesitant users.

2.5. Literature Review

The global matrimonial market has grown steadily (around 8–12% annually, 2020–2025), with the Asia-Pacific region, including Pakistan, showing especially strong, mobile-first adoption. In Pakistan, rising internet penetration and urban acceptance of online services coexist with a strong preference for family-mediated, privacy-sensitive matching. Islamic-aligned platforms that combine technology with moderation, halal-compliant payments, and family involvement report higher trust and conversion rates.

Table 2.5.1 provides an overview of existing applications that are similar to Nikkah Network

Dimension	**Key Insight**
Global Growth	8–12% annual growth (2020–2025); Asia-Pacific
Pakistani Market	~90M internet users; growing acceptance of digital matrimonial platforms.
Cultural Preference	Strong tilt towards family-mediated, non-anonymous matching.

Privacy & Trust	Users prefer smaller, trusted local platforms with strong privacy protections.
Islamic Compliance	Islamic-aligned, moderated platforms show higher trust and 30-40% better conversion.

2.6. Unique Approach

Nikah Network differs from typical platforms through a hybrid registration model that supports both self-service and staff-assisted onboarding, making it accessible even to tech-hesitant users. Matching is AI-assisted, using transparent rules and weighted scoring while keeping final authority with staff. Communication is via structured, time-bound, moderated Q&A rather than open chat, aligning with Islamic norms and reducing harassment. Progression of matches requires dual approval (mutual interest plus staff review), improving quality and safeguarding values. The platform emphasizes Pakistan-based hosting, strict privacy, and clear, affordable pricing (e.g., PKR 4,000) that staff can transparently explain to families.

3. Methodology

3.1. Overview of Platform Components

As Nikah Network will be developed using a five-phase modular approach, allowing progressive delivery and validation.

Table 3.1 provides a five-phase modular approach

Phase	**Component**	**Duration**	**Outcome**
Phase 1	Planning, Administrative Setup, and Database	Weeks 1–3	Staff dashboard core ready.
Phase 2	Registration and Profile System	Weeks 4–5	Users can register and staff can approve profiles.
Phase 3	Matching Algorithm	Weeks 6–7	Suggested matches begin to appear (e.g., daily).
Phase 4	Question-and-Answer Communication and Approval	Weeks 8-10	Users interact via moderated Q&A; staff can approve or halt matches.
Phase 5	Testing, Training, and Launch	Weeks 11–12	Platform goes live with trained staff and initial pilot users.

3.2. Matching Methodology

Nikah Network uses a two step matching approach:

1. **Hard Filters (Must Match Rules)**

Profiles are first filtered on key criteria:

- Caste compatibility (including “only same caste” where specified)
- Preferred age range, height etc.
- Location (e.g., “Lahore only” / nearby areas; no long distance in Phase 1)

2. **Weighted Scoring (0–100 Points)**

Remaining profiles are scored to rank compatibility:

- Caste match (up to 25 points)
- Profession compatibility (up to 15 points)
- Age gap suitability (up to 15 points)
- Distance/City match (up to 15 points)
- Height preference alignment (up to 10 points)
- House ownership compatibility (up to 10 points)
- House area similarity (up to 10 points)

3.3. Duplicate Detection Methodology

Nikah Network uses a multi-layer duplicate detection approach to prevent the same person from registering multiple times

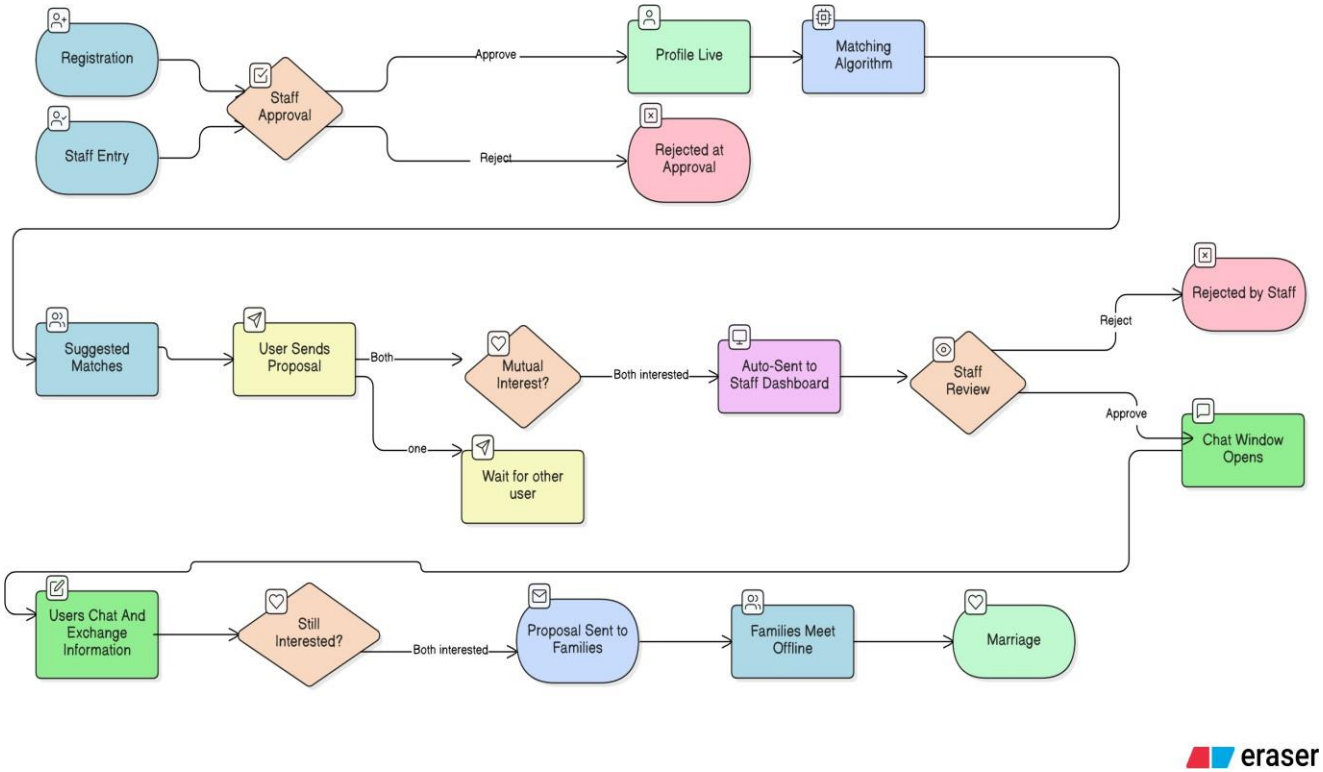
Table 3.3.1 Multi-Layer Duplicate Detection in Nikah Network

Layer	**Criteria / Logic**	**Action**
Layer 1: Exact Match	Same normalized phone, same email, or same CNIC/passport	Immediate block/rejection

Layer 2: Fuzzy Matching	Same first name + same city + age within 1 year	Flag for manual staff review
Layer 3: Family Contact No.	Same "family contact number" across two or more registrations	Flag for manual staff review

3.4. Data Flow

Figure 3.4.1 Data Flow of Nikkah Network



3.5. Communication Flow

Nikah Network uses pre-written questions to structure communication between potential matches. These questions focus on expectations around profession, family life, residence, and lifestyle, as well as education, health, and long-term goals.

Table 3.5.1 Communication Flow of Nikkah Network

Category	**Example Questions**
Partner Expectations	What is your ideal profession for a partner?; What

	qualities are most important to you in a partner?
Family and Children	How many children do you want?; Describe your family situation (parents, siblings, etc.).
Residence Preferences	What areas of Lahore do you prefer to live in?; What are your expectations for house type (own vs. rent)?
Education and Career	What is your educational background?; What are your career goals for the next 5 years?
Lifestyle and Health	How would you describe your daily routine/lifestyle?; Any health conditions we should be aware of?

3.6. Moderation Process

What Staff Reviews

Table 3.6.1 Moderation Process of Nikkah Network

Content Type	**Review Trigger**	**Action**
Q&A answers	All answers (automated scan)	Flag if: inappropriate language, health disclosure overshare, contact sharing
Profile photos	On upload	Check for: appropriate attire, family photos only, no duplicates from other sites

4. Feasibility Plan

4.1.1 Tools/Technology

Table 4.1.1 Development Stack of Nikkah Network

Category	**Tool**	**Purpose**

Frontend	React.js	User portal and dashboard UI
Backend	Node.js + Express.js	API server, business logic
Database	MongoDB	User data, profiles, matches, Q&A
Authentication	JWT + bcrypt	Secure login, password encryption
Payment	JazzCash API	PKR 4,000 subscription processing
Email/SMS	SendGrid / AWS SNS	Notifications, verification codes
Hosting	AWS EC2 / DigitalOcean	Server infrastructure (Pakistan-based)
Storage	AWS S3 / MongoDB GridFS	Photo storage, backups
Testing	Jest + Postman	Unit tests, API testing
Version Control	GitHub	Code management

Table 4.1.2 Operational Tools of Nikkah Network

Tool	**Purpose**	**Cost**
Figma	UI/UX design mockups	Free/Paid tier
Trello/Asana	Project management, milestone tracking	Free tier
Slack	Team communication	Free tier
Google Workspace	Docs, sheets, presentations	Free tier
Jira	Bug tracking, sprint planning	Free tier for small team

4.1.2 Budget

Initial Infrastructure Investment

Table 4.1.2.1 Initial Infrastructure Investment of Nikkah Network

Item	**Cost (PKR)**	**Justification**	**Notes**
Domain Name (.pk)	3,000	nikah-network.pk or similar	2-year registration
JazzCash API Setup	2,000	Payment gateway integration setup	Transaction fee: 1–2% per subscription
AI Matching Model	3,000	Fine-tuning rules and testing	Can start with simple rules, upgrade later
SSL Certificate (Let's	0	TLS security for	Free with Render/Vercel,

Encrypt)		production	auto-renewable
Contingency Buffer	2,000	Unexpected setup or configuration costs	Reserved for critical needs
TOTAL INFRASTRUCTURE	10,000	—	Within the targeted initial budget

Table 4.1.2.2 Milestone Breakdown of Nikkah Network

Milestone	**Deliverable**	**Fee (PKR)**	**Percentage**
M1	Database + Admin Setup	40,000	20%
M2	Registration + Profiles	40,000	20%
M3	Matching Algorithm	40,000	20%
M4	Chat + Approval Workflow	40,000	20%
M5	Testing + Training + Launch	40,000	20%
TOTAL	—	200,000	100%

4.1.3 Payment schedule

Table 4.1.3.1 Milestone Breakdown of Nikkah Network

Phase	**Timing**		**Deliverable**	**Amount (PKR)**
Advance	Week 0		Project kickoff, infra setup	20,000 (10%)
M1	End Week 3		Database + Admin live	40,000 (20%)
M2	End Week 5		Registration system live	40,000 (20%)
M3	End Week 7		Matching engine live	40,000 (20%)
M4	End Week 10		Chat + approval workflow live	40,000 (20%)
M5	End Week 12		Platform live & tested	30,000 (10%)
TOTAL	—		—	210,000

4.1.4 Included vs Not Included

Included :

- Full-stack development (frontend, backend, database)
- Domain (2 years) and SSL (Let's Encrypt)
- JazzCash integration
- Hosting (Firebase, Render, MongoDB Atlas)
- AI-assisted matching algorithm
- Staff dashboard, user portal, Q&A window
- Moderation tools, basic email/SMS notifications
- Backup/security setup
- 1 staff training session (2 hours), user docs
- 2 weeks post-launch support
- GitHub code repository

Not Included (Future Upgrades):

- Premium hosting (paid tiers as users scale)
- Mobile app
- Advanced AI/ML features
- Multi-language support
- Video call integration
- Extended training beyond 1 session
- Professional branding

4.1.5 ROI for Falah Khandan Center

Client Returns (Year 1)

Table 4.1.5.1 ROI for Falah Khandan Center

Source	Calculation	Revenue (PKR)
User Subscriptions (Current Manual)	431 users × 4,000	1,724,000
User Subscriptions (Digital, +30%)	560 users × 4,000	2,240,000
Incremental Revenue (Digital Gain)	2,240,000 − 1,724,000	516,000
Staff Efficiency (Time Saved)	40% time saved	---

5. Key Milestones and schedule

Milestone 1: Planning & Core Setup

Duration: Weeks 1–3 (21 days)
Fee: PKR 40,000 (20%)

Deliverables:

- MongoDB Atlas free-tier database created
- GitHub repository set up
- Firebase project initialized
- Render backend server configured
- Admin dashboard skeleton (login only)
- Audit logging system in place
- Domain registered (nikah-network.pk)

Acceptance Criteria:

- Database accessible with zero errors
- Admin can log in securely
- GitHub repository contains initial commit
- Firebase hosting connected and serving app
- Render server running and reachable
- Domain correctly pointing to Firebase
- No major security vulnerabilities identified

Go/No-Go Decision: If any core service fails or is unstable, fix and retest before starting Milestone 2.

Milestone 2: Registration & Profile System

Duration: Weeks 4–5 (14 days)
Fee: PKR 40,000 (20%)

Deliverables:

- User registration form (digital self-signup)

- Staff data entry form (for paper/WhatsApp cases)
- Photo upload (via MongoDB GridFS or equivalent)
- Profile approval workflow
- Email verification (Gmail SMTP)
- Explicitly include staff profile creation workflow
- 15 test user profiles created and approved

Acceptance Criteria:

- User can complete registration
- Staff can register users from offline data
- Photos upload, store, and display correctly
- Email verification works reliably
- At least 15 test profiles approved end-to-end
- No database errors during registration and profile flows

Go/No-Go Decision: If registration is unstable or confusing, iterate in Week 5 before starting Milestone 3.

Milestone 3: Matching Algorithm

Duration: Weeks 6–7 (14 days)

Fee: PKR 40,000 (20%)

Deliverables:

- Hard filter system (caste, age, location, required fields)
- Simple weighted scoring (100-point system)
- Suggested matches display
- Matching transparency (score and breakdown visible)
- Basic duplicate detection (phone and email)
- Include automatic match generation in staff dashboard.
- At least 15 profiles generating relevant matches

Sample Scoring System (100 Points):

- Caste Match: 25
- Profession Match: 15
- Age Gap Ideal: 15
- City Match: 15
- Height Preference: 10
- House Status: 10
- House Area: 10

Acceptance Criteria:

- Suggested matches loads
- Hard filters correctly exclude incompatible profiles

- Score breakdown clearly visible to staff
- Suggested matches judged "relevant" by staff (≥70% approval)

Go/No-Go Decision: If matching accuracy is below 70%, refine algorithm in Week 7 before Milestone 4.

Milestone 4: Chat Window & Approval Workflow

Duration: Weeks 8–10 (21 days)
Fee: PKR 40,000 (20%)

Deliverables:

- "Send Proposal Request" button
- Mutual interest detection (both sides agree)
- Staff approval dashboard with Approve/Reject actions
- Text-only chat window between matched parties
- Notifications (Email + SMS via JazzCash or equivalent)
- End-to-end workflow tested from match to proposal

Acceptance Criteria:

- "Send Proposal Request" works as expected
- Mutual interest correctly identified before chat opens
- Staff see simple controls (Approve/Reject) for each case
- Chat opens only after staff approval
- Chat timer closes conversation after configured period
- Notifications sent correctly on key events
- Full end-to-end scenario passes (from match → proposal → staff decision)

Go/No-Go Decision: If the workflow is confusing for staff or users, refine in Week 10 before Milestone 5.

Milestone 5: Testing, Training & Launch

Duration: Weeks 11–12 (14 days)
Fee: PKR 10,000 (5%)

Deliverables:

- Complete system testing (functional, basic performance, security)
- All critical (P1) and major (P2) bugs resolved
- Staff training session (1 session, 2 hours)
- User documentation (FAQ and basic help guide)
- Pilot launch with 20–30 real users
- Production deployment live on Firebase/Render
- Post-launch support for 2 weeks

Acceptance Criteria:

- No critical bugs outstanding at launch
- 20–30 pilot users registered and active
- Staff report confidence in using the system (survey ≥4/5)

- Platform deployed and stable in production
- Documentation available and shared with staff

5.1. Gantt Chart

Activity	**Weeks**															
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
Planning & Core Setup (Apr 21 - May 11)																
Registration & Profiles (May 15 - May 25)																
Matching Engine (May 29 - Jun 8)																
Chat & Approval Workflow (Jun 12 - Jun 29)																
Testing, Training & Launch (Jul 3 - Jul 13)																

6. Risks and Mitigation

Risk Assessment

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Free tier outage	Low	Medium	Use Render + Railway as backup; be ready to migrate quickly if needed.
Database storage limit (512MB)	Low (50 users ≈ 500MB)	Medium	Upgrade to a paid MongoDB tier once there are 50+ active users.
Scope creep	High	High	Freeze scope by Week 2; treat additional features as paid add-ons.
Development delays	Medium	Medium	Use weekly tracking; adjust plan within the 270-hour budget.
JazzCash API issues	Very Low	High	Maintain manual invoice/transfer backup; prepare support tickets.
Data loss	Very Low	Critical	Use GitHub for code backup and daily MongoDB Atlas backups.